

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*

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## Al Baster

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*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

# INTRODUCTIONS



**Al Baster**

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## *Sculptor & Public-Art Star*

Al considers a pedestal a sculpture that has given up on itself. Al makes monumental sculpture in stone, steel, and whatever else can require a crane.

- **Frank Lloyd Wrong** designed the entrance around Al's sculpture. They still disagree about which one visitors came to see.
- Competes with **Vincent Van Faux** for commissions. Al keeps calculating how many paintings weigh as much as one sculpture.
- **Dada DiCapo** once performed inside one of Al's sculptures. Al found out from the photographs.

## **ACTING TIPS**

Big presence, playful arrogance, generous when admired, combative when minimized.

## **YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD**

I'm Al Baster. I made the entrance sculpture. I would appreciate your admiration in a tone that suggests prompt payment.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

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Al Baster

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## Behind the portrait

### Your grievance with Grant

Grant planned to replace your commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after the opening and dispute your final payment.

### Your other secret

You built one internal support differently from the approved plan because the fabricator missed a deadline.

### Conversations to start

- Ask Frank Lloyd Wrong whether the entrance display still includes your original sculpture.
- Ask Vincent Van Faux how he handles patrons who try to replace an artist's work.

*If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings.*

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



# The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Find the frame that always contains a portrait of you; check its top.*
- 2 *A wall-hung painting has a backstage area. That is where to investigate.*
- 3 *A blue cushion has been acting as a very quiet accomplice. Check its reverse.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

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*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

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Al Baster

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

Grant planned to replace my entrance sculpture with a cheap replica and dispute the final payment. I changed one internal support when the fabricator missed the deadline. That change should have been approved. He discovered it and decided the entire commission could be treated as defective. He was still happy to be photographed beside it.

#### IF MURDERER

He wanted a replica at the door and an unpaid sculptor outside it. I had altered an internal support without approval. Grant meant to use that alteration to cancel the bill while keeping the opening-night photographs. I can take criticism of a support. I object to a donor using it to support his own theft.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Al Baster

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

Where were you before the toast, and why?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

Where did your work take you before the toast?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

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*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

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Al Baster

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

I went to the load-test rig before the toast. The support had to hold under tension, and I held the armature while the recorder ran. I came back with plaster on my hand and a better answer than 'it should probably stand up.' The entrance piece remains mine until somebody pays the invoice.

#### IF MURDERER

The rig's recorded test was running while I checked the entrance piece in the gallery. I had inspected its support earlier. Before the toast I wiped my hand and went back to the outer worktable with the invoice. Grant had already seen the amended plan in his salon and chosen to misunderstand it.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Al Baster

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# Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What materials or records passed through your hands?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

Which objects or records need your explanation?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

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*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

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Al Baster

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# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

My plaster thumb is in the raw load-test film throughout the 6:49–6:55 brass overlay; the force never releases. I hid the support revision inside the invoice. The welded brace differs from the approved drawing. It held, and I wanted Grant to inspect that result before calling the whole commission defective.

## IF MURDERER

The plaster thumb came from an earlier adjustment. I put the support revision inside the invoice, where Grant could compare it with his replica estimate. The welded brace was not on the approved plan. I had tested it before the gala. He wanted to keep the opening photographs and replace the sculpture carrying my name.

*The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Al Baster

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# Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Tear off this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

**Your character name**

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**I accuse**

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**Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction**

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**Best Actor**

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**Best Costume**

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Al Baster

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# The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

### IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I altered the support without approval and concealed the revised drawing. The raw load test shows me holding the armature throughout the real contamination interval after the overlay correction. I wanted payment for the work Grant was displaying. I did not poison him. The sculpture is sound; our agreement was not.

### IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I let the recorded rig test stand in for my whereabouts. With the mounting cloth and reference toxin I coated Grant's empty coupe before returning to the invoice. He intended to keep the photographs, replace the sculpture and pay for neither properly. I decided that he would not get the chance.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*